The Claw Family: PicoClaw, ZeroClaw, NemoClaw, IronClaw, and MimiClaw

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OpenClaw's explosive growth has produced a family of independent projects, each rewriting the personal AI agent concept for a different niche. PicoClaw is written entirely in Go, runs in under 10MB of RAM, boots in under one second, and deploys on $10 RISC-V boards, ARM, MIPS, and x86 as a single binary. It supports 30+ LLM providers and 18 messaging channels, with an Android APK released in March 2026. ZeroClaw, built by Harvard and MIT students,

is 100% Rust with 281 contributors and 144 releases. It uses under 5MB of RAM, includes OS-level sandboxing (Landlock, Bubblewrap, Seatbelt, Docker), cryptographic tool receipts on every action, and hardware GPIO support for Raspberry Pi and ESP32.

MimiClaw goes further: it runs on a $5 ESP32-S3 chip in pure C with no Linux, no Node.js, and 0.5W power draw. It connects to Telegram over WiFi and supports both Anthropic and OpenAI as providers. NemoClaw, released by NVIDIA at GTC on March 16, 2026, adds the OpenShell secure runtime on top of OpenClaw with managed inference through Nemotron models. IronClaw by NEAR AI is a Rust rewrite focused on privacy: WASM sandboxing for untrusted tools, local encryption, and zero telemetry.

The fragmentation mirrors Linux's evolution from one kernel into Ubuntu, Alpine, and CentOS for different use cases. MimiClaw on a $5 chip and PicoClaw on a $10 board prove AI agents can run on hardware cheaper than a month of API costs. ZeroClaw's Rust rewrite with cryptographic receipts directly addresses the security failures that plagued OpenClaw's original TypeScript codebase.

Read More: OpenClaw Three Months Later: 3.2 Million Users, Nine CVEs, and an OpenAI Acquisition

Sources:

- PicoClaw by Sipeed (GitHub)
- ZeroClaw by ZeroClaw Labs (GitHub)
- MimiClaw by memovai (GitHub)
- NVIDIA NemoClaw (GitHub)
- IronClaw by NEAR AI (GitHub)
- A Quick Look at Claw-Family (DEV Community)

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